REQUEST FOR INFORMATION

QUESTIONS & ANSWERS

36C10B26Q0218 Amend 02

Enterprise Data Center and Telecommunications Modernization (EDCTM)

March 9, 2026

QUESTION #3: Can this request please be extended to 3/18?

ANSWER #3: Yes; the response due date is extended to 2:00 pm Eastern, March 18, 2026. The Department of Veterans Affairs operates one of the largest and most geographically dispersed federal IT facility portfolios in the country, encompassing approximately 1,500 facilities with data centers, computer rooms, and telecommunications spaces supporting clinical, administrative, and mission-critical operations. No two of these environments are identically configured. They span decades of construction, reflect varying levels of prior investment and standardization, and are subject to different seismic, electrical code, and authority-having-jurisdiction requirements based on their location.

The Government is not seeking responses that simply mirror the requirements as stated; rather, we are seeking the professional judgment and commercial experience of firms that build, modernize, and maintain data center and telecommunications infrastructure at scale. Industry's insights at this stage will directly inform the refinement of requirements and the acquisition strategy prior to solicitation.

QUESTION #4: Are there any hardware specs and will they be released before you move to the next step?

ANSWER #4: See Attachment 1; it provides representative product categories and salient characteristics across four infrastructure domains: Telecommunications and Information Technology (IT) Infrastructure, Power and Electrical Infrastructure, Environmental and Cooling Infrastructure, and Facilities and Life Safety Infrastructure. VA seeks recommendation on a procurement strategy for structuring specific quantities and configurations for ease of order execution. The Government intends to refine product specifications based on industry feedback.

QUESTION #5: Please confirm whether this requirement includes any architectural or structural building modifications such as slab reinforcement, seismic retrofitting, roof penetrations, or structural engineering certifications, as neither [vendor or vendor] publicly markets themselves as general construction prime contractors or structural engineering firms.

ANSWER #5: The primary scope of this effort is the modernization of data center and telecommunications physical infrastructure within existing VA facility spaces. This includes equipment racks, structured cabling, power distribution, cooling systems, fire suppression, and associated turnkey installation services. See Attachment 1 for representative product categories and requirements. The scope does not include major architectural or structural building modifications such as slab reinforcement, large-scale seismic retrofitting of building structures, roof penetrations, or structural engineering certifications. However, seismic anchoring and bracing of installed telecommunications equipment (e.g., racks and cabinets) is required per VA seismic zone requirements as reflected in the Equipment Racks, Cabinets, and Enclosures category in Attachment 1. Where site conditions require minor structural accommodations incidental to infrastructure installation, VA seeks recommendation on a procurement strategy. Major structural modifications, if needed, would be managed separately by VA Facilities Management.

The Government welcomes recommendations on additional categories, alternative bundling approaches, or other considerations

QUESTION #6: Please confirm whether the scope includes utility-side upgrades, medium-voltage switchyard work, or coordination directly with local electric utilities, as [vendor] delivers downstream critical power infrastructure, but large-scale utility interconnection work may require separate specialty electrical contractors.

ANSWER #6: Contractor responsibility begins at the point of connection to the existing facility electrical distribution serving the data center or telecommunications space. The scope of this effort is focused on downstream critical power infrastructure within the data center and telecommunications environment. See Attachment 1, Power and Electrical Infrastructure table, which identifies rack-level and room-level power distribution units (PDUs), busway systems, power whips, and grounding and bonding infrastructure. Utility-side upgrades, medium-voltage switchyard work, or direct coordination with local electric utilities are not required. The Government manages utility-side infrastructure separately.

QUESTION #7: Please clarify whether the project requires chilled water plant redesign, central plant mechanical engineering, or building automation system re-architecture beyond Schneiders EcoStruxure layer, since full mechanical plant redesign is not presented as a core [vendor] service line.

ANSWER #7: The scope of environmental and cooling work under this effort is limited to the replacement, installation, and commissioning of in-room cooling systems directly serving data center and telecommunications spaces. See Attachment 1, Environmental and Cooling Infrastructure table, which identifies cooling systems (CRAC/CRAH units), hot aisle/cold aisle containment, and environmental monitoring sensors. Full chilled water plant redesign, central plant mechanical engineering, or building automation system (BAS) re-architecture at the facility level is not within the scope of this requirement. Where new cooling equipment must integrate with existing building systems (e.g., chilled water loop connections), the contractor is expected to coordinate with VA facility engineering staff. Integration with VA environmental monitoring platforms is in scope; however, enterprise-level BAS redesign is not.

QUESTION #8: Please confirm whether the scope includes enterprise IT application migration, server virtualization, storage refresh, or cloud transition activities, as [vendor] markets infrastructure integration and modernization but not hyperscale migration execution under this RFI context.

ANSWER #8: No. The scope of this effort is limited to physical data center and telecommunications infrastructure modernization as represented in Attachment 1. This includes structured cabling, power distribution, cooling, fire suppression, racks/cabinets, and associated turnkey installation services. Enterprise IT application migration, server virtualization, storage refresh, compute hardware, and cloud transition activities are expressly outside the scope of this requirement. Those activities are managed under separate VA acquisition programs.

QUESTION #9: Please clarify whether 24x7 nationwide field break-fix with guaranteed on-site SLAs across approximately 10,000 telecom spaces is required as a prime contractual obligation, or whether OEM manufacturer service agreements are acceptable, since [vendor] site does not represent itself as a self-performing nationwide facilities maintenance organization.

ANSWER #9: This acquisition is structured as a project-based, deliverables-driven effort—not a managed services or ongoing maintenance contract. The Government does not anticipate requiring 24x7 nationwide break-fix with guaranteed on-site SLAs as a prime contractual obligation under this effort. Each deliverable is expected to be a completed, accepted, and operational (e.g., a fully installed and certified cabling system or cooling unit replacement). See Attachment 1 for the representative product categories and bundled services expected with each deliverable. VA seeks a recommended acquisition strategy for post-installation warranty terms and extended maintenance. Ongoing maintenance of installed infrastructure will be managed by VA through separate arrangements.

QUESTION #10: Please confirm whether hazardous material abatement, asbestos removal, or environmental remediation is in scope, as neither firm publicly positions itself as an environmental remediation contractor.

ANSWER #10: Hazardous material abatement, asbestos removal, and environmental remediation are not within the primary scope of this effort. However, where removal or decommissioning of existing infrastructure is part of a deliverable (e.g., replacing an aging CRAC unit or removing legacy cabling as referenced in Attachment 1), the contractor may encounter conditions requiring coordination with VA environmental and safety staff. In such cases, the contractor is expected to identify the condition and stop work in the affected area pending Government direction. The Government will manage any required environmental remediation through appropriate channels. Respondents are encouraged to describe in their RFI responses how they typically handle discovery of hazardous conditions during data center modernization projects.

QUESTION #11: Please clarify whether the requirement includes certified commissioning authority (CxA) services independent of installation, stamped PE drawings in all 50 states, or third-party code compliance certification, since [vendor] provides commissioning support but independent authority services may require separate licensed engineering entities.

ANSWER #11: Services involving the commissioning of installed systems (startup, functional testing, and verification of operational performance) is expected as part of bundled turnkey services for applicable deliverables such as cooling systems and fire suppression installations. See Attachment 1 for bundled service expectations associated with each product category. Where local Authority Having Jurisdiction (AHJ) requirements mandate stamped Professional Engineer (PE) drawings or third-party code compliance certifications, VA seeks a recommended acquisition strategy. The Government recognizes that PE licensure requirements vary by state and jurisdiction. The Government does not anticipate requiring independent Commissioning Authority (CxA) services but welcomes industry input on how best to structure commissioning and certification responsibilities.

QUESTION #12: Please confirm whether the Government expects ownership and operation of a centralized enterprise DCIM hosting platform within a FedRAMP-authorized cloud, as [vendor] provides DCIM software but hosting, continuous monitoring, and federal cloud authorization may require separate infrastructure.

ANSWER #12: The Government does not currently anticipate requiring ownership and operation of a centralized enterprise DCIM hosting platform within a FedRAMP-authorized cloud as part of this acquisition. Attachment 1 includes environmental monitoring sensors that must be compatible with VA environmental monitoring platforms, but this refers to integration with existing VA systems—not contractor-hosted DCIM. Respondents are requested to describe DCIM capabilities and hosting models in their RFI responses for the Government's consideration in shaping the overall modernization strategy.

QUESTION #13: Please clarify whether the project includes relocation or disposal of legacy batteries and equipment under federal hazardous waste regulations with cradle-to-grave liability, and whether Government will manage disposal contracts.

ANSWER #13: Where deliverables include removal or decommissioning of existing infrastructure (e.g., replacing legacy cooling units, UPS batteries, or outdated cabling as referenced in Attachment 1), the contractor is responsible for safe removal and staging of decommissioned equipment at a Government-designated location on site. Disposal of legacy batteries, equipment containing hazardous materials, or items subject to federal hazardous waste regulations (e.g., RCRA) will be managed by the Government through its own disposal processes and contracts. The contractor will not assume cradle-to-grave liability for hazardous waste disposal. Respondents are encouraged to describe their standard approach to decommissioning and removal of legacy data center equipment in their RFI responses.

QUESTION #14: Can the VA provide a list of sites that are in scope for this effort, their geographic location, and relative size? This would assist in providing the government with more precise, actionable recommendations as part of this RFI.

ANSWER #14: VA OIT manages a geographically distributed portfolio of data centers, computer rooms, and telecommunications spaces across approximately 1,500 facilities supporting clinical, administrative, and mission-critical systems. A specific site list with locations and relative sizes is not available for release at this stage of market research. The Government recognizes that site variability is a significant pricing factor and is considering tiered pricing mechanisms (e.g., site complexity modifiers) to enable fair pricing while managing site-unseen risk. Respondents are encouraged to describe in their RFI responses how they typically approach pricing for geographically dispersed, variable-condition facility portfolios, and what site information they would need to provide competitive firm-fixed pricing. See Attachment 1 for the representative product categories and requirements that would apply across all sites.

QUESTION #15: Would the government consider a migration of IT services into government-approved commercial cloud environments (such as AWS GovCloud), or is this effort strictly limited to modernizing and standardizing on-prem datacenters?

ANSWER #15: This effort is strictly limited to the modernization and standardization of on-premises physical data center and telecommunications infrastructure. See Attachment 1 for the representative product categories, which are exclusively physical infrastructure components (racks, cabling, power distribution, cooling, fire suppression) with bundled turnkey installation services. Cloud migration, IT service migration, and compute/storage modernization are expressly outside the scope of this requirement and are managed under separate VA acquisition programs.

QUESTION #16: Physical security components supporting telecommunications spaces – Need additional information on any specific equipment. Could you please provide additional information on the physical security components supporting the telecommunications spaces, including any specific equipment that is being utilized?

ANSWER #16: See Attachment 1, Facilities and Life Safety Infrastructure table, which identifies physical security infrastructure as an in-scope product category with bundled installation and integration services. The Government has intentionally described this category at the salient-characteristic level (access control, CCTV, physical barriers) rather than specifying particular manufacturers, models, or technologies. This is consistent with the overall acquisition approach: the Government is seeking standardized, brand-agnostic infrastructure components that can be deployed across VA's diverse facility portfolio. Specific physical security equipment requirements will vary by site based on existing security systems, facility classification, and local VA security office requirements. The Government recognizes the need to identify the applicable security integration requirements for each site, including compatibility with existing VA physical security and access control platforms. Respondents are encouraged to describe in their RFI responses the range of physical security solutions they are capable of providing for telecommunications and data center environments, including access control systems, video surveillance, and physical barrier solutions, as well as their approach to integrating new components with existing facility security infrastructure.